



Are Research-Based Predictors of Postschool Outcomes Evident in College-Based Transition Programs?

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Moving Transition Forward: Exploration of College-based and Conventional Transition Practices for Students with Intellectual Disability and Autism (ID/A) project will examine the composition and impact of existing transition practices via secondary analysis of two national datasets. This three-phase study will define, explore, and compare critical aspects of two transition approaches:

1. a college-based transition experience provided via partnership between a local education agencies (LEAs) and institutions of higher education (IHEs), and
2. a conventional transition experience offered by a LEA in a high school or community setting.



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MTF Studies

MOVING TRANSITION FORWARD STUDIES

**Conventional Transition
Services (NLTS 2012)**



**College-Based Transition
Services (TPSID)**

→ Study 1 Research-Based Predictors	Research-Based Predictors Study 4 ←
→ Study 2 Employment Preparation	Employment Preparation Study 5 ←
→ Study 3 College Preparation	College Preparation Study 6 ←



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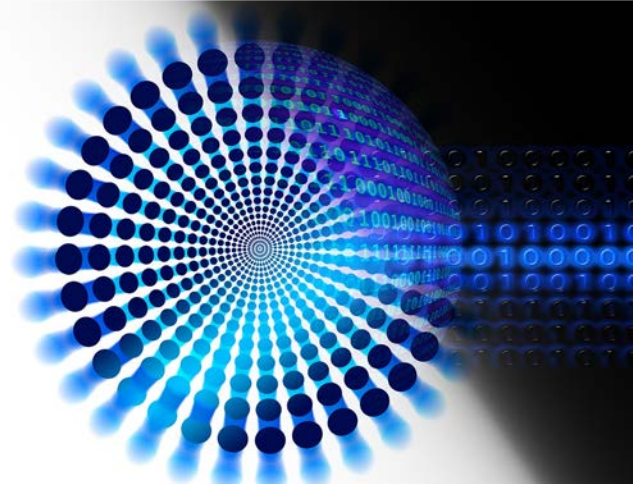
College-based transition services

- Transition aged students with ID and autism access learning and working experiences in college settings
- May be called dual or concurrent enrollment
- About 40% of IHE programs enrolling youth w/ ID/A serve transition aged students(Think College, 2021).



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Our Datasets



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Transition and Postsecondary Programs for Students with Intellectual Disabilities (TPSID): College-Based Transition Experiences

In 2010, 27 TPSID projects were funded at institutions of higher education in 23 states

2010-2015: served over 400 youth with ID/A who were between the ages of 18 and 22 and still receiving special education services under IDEA.



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NLTS 2012: “Conventional Transition Experiences”

- Nationally representative sample of about 13,000 youth ages 13-21 during 2011-12 school year
- Phase 1: Surveys completed with parents and students

Phase 2 (in progress): high school and post-high school administrative records data to collect information in three broad areas important to understanding outcomes for youth with disabilities: (1) High school course-taking and completion (2) post-secondary education and training, and (3) employment and earnings after high school.



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NTACT's In-School Predictors of Post-School Success



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<https://transitionta.org/predictors-of-post-school-success/>

NTACT
THE COLLABORATIVE

National Technical
Assistance Center
on Transition

Home Training & TA Topics News COVID About Join Us Search

Content Library Predictors of Post School Success



Predictors of Post School Success



This chart outlines predictors of post school success in three categories: education, employment, and independent living. Each predictors has been evaluated regarding the amount, type, and quality of the research conducted, and are labeled as either (a) evidence-based, (b) research-based, or (c) promising. These designations indicate the confidence one can have in the likely effectiveness of the intervention when implemented as defined

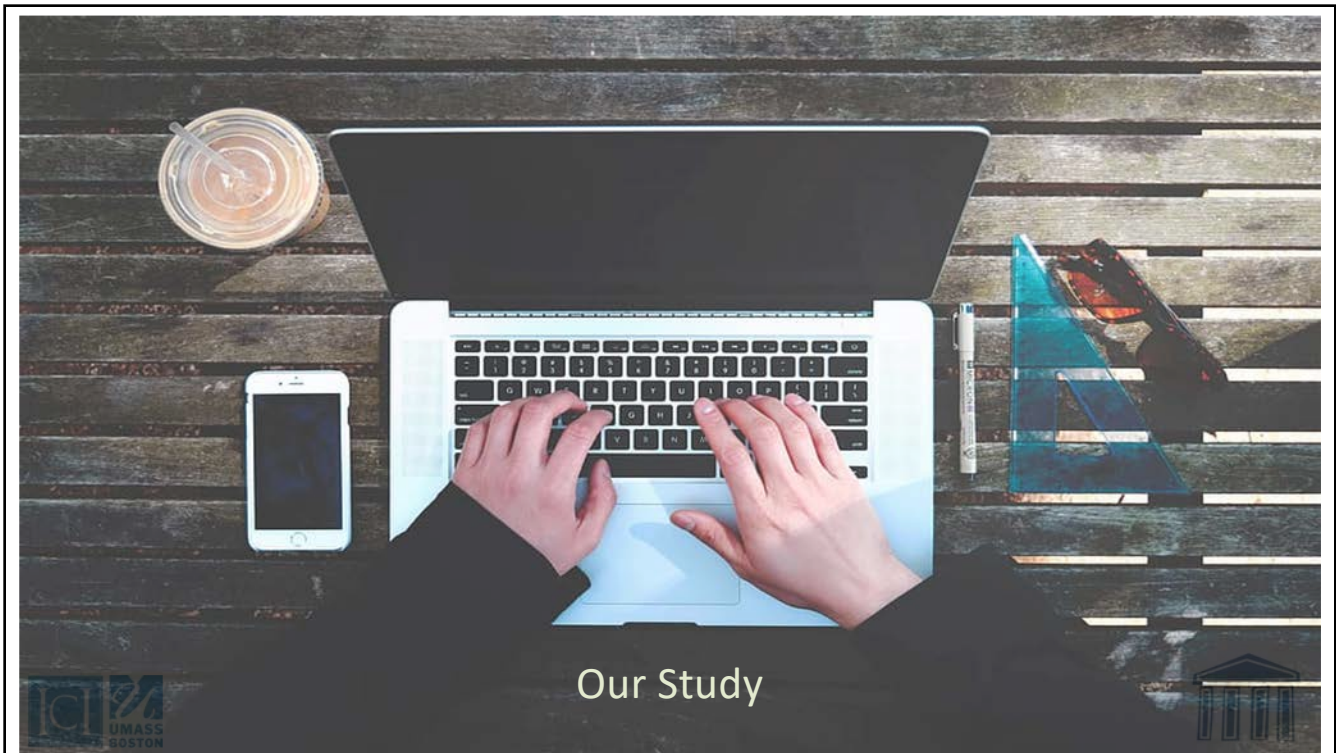
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Predictors of post-school success

Career awareness	Paid employment	Social skills
Career technical education	Parent expectations	Student support
Community experiences	Parent involvement	Technology skills
Exit exam/diploma status	Program of study	Transition program
Goal setting	Psychological empowerment	Travel skills
Inclusion in general ed	Self-care/ind living skills	Work study
Interagency collaboration	Self-determination	Youth autonomy
Occupational courses	Self-realization	



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Research question

To what extent are in-school predictors of post-school success reflected in the experiences of youth with ID/A in college-based transition programs vs. conventional transition experiences?

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Samples

NLTS 2012

- 1,400 youth with ID (includes youth with autism and ID)

TPSID

- 359 students who had ID/A and were reported to have received special education services under IDEA for at least one year of their attendance



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Variable selection process

- Reviewed predictor definitions and original research
- Reviewed TPSID and NLTS 2012 data dictionaries and published reports
- Identified variables in TPSID and NLTS 2012 that most closely matched definitions and prior research



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Variable selection process, continued

TPSID

- Matched 13 predictors
 - Three predictors (parent involvement, student supports, paid employment/work experience) each had 2-3 variables that matched
- No match for 10 predictors

NLTS 2012

- Matched 15 predictors
 - One predictor (parent involvement) had 3 variables that matched
- No match for 8 predictors



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Example: Parent involvement

NLTS 2012

- Parent or another household adult attended an IEP meeting in the past two years

TPSID

- Youth attended a program that provided any kind of orientation experience to families of students attending the program



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Example: Occupational courses

NLTS 2012

- Youth took classes to prepare for a career

TPSID

- Youth enrolled in at least 1 course for which the purpose of taking the course was related to their career goals



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Predictors we could not examine

NLTS 2012

- Career and technical education
- Community experiences
- Exit exam requirements/high school diploma status
- Goal setting
- Inclusion in general education
- Program of study
- Student support
- Technology skills

TPSID

- Community experiences (all of CBTS is this)
- Transition program (all of CBTS is this)
- Goal setting
- Parent expectations
- Exit exam requirements/high school diploma status
- Self-determination/self-advocacy
- Youth autonomy/decision making
- Psychological empowerment
- Self-realization
- Technology skills

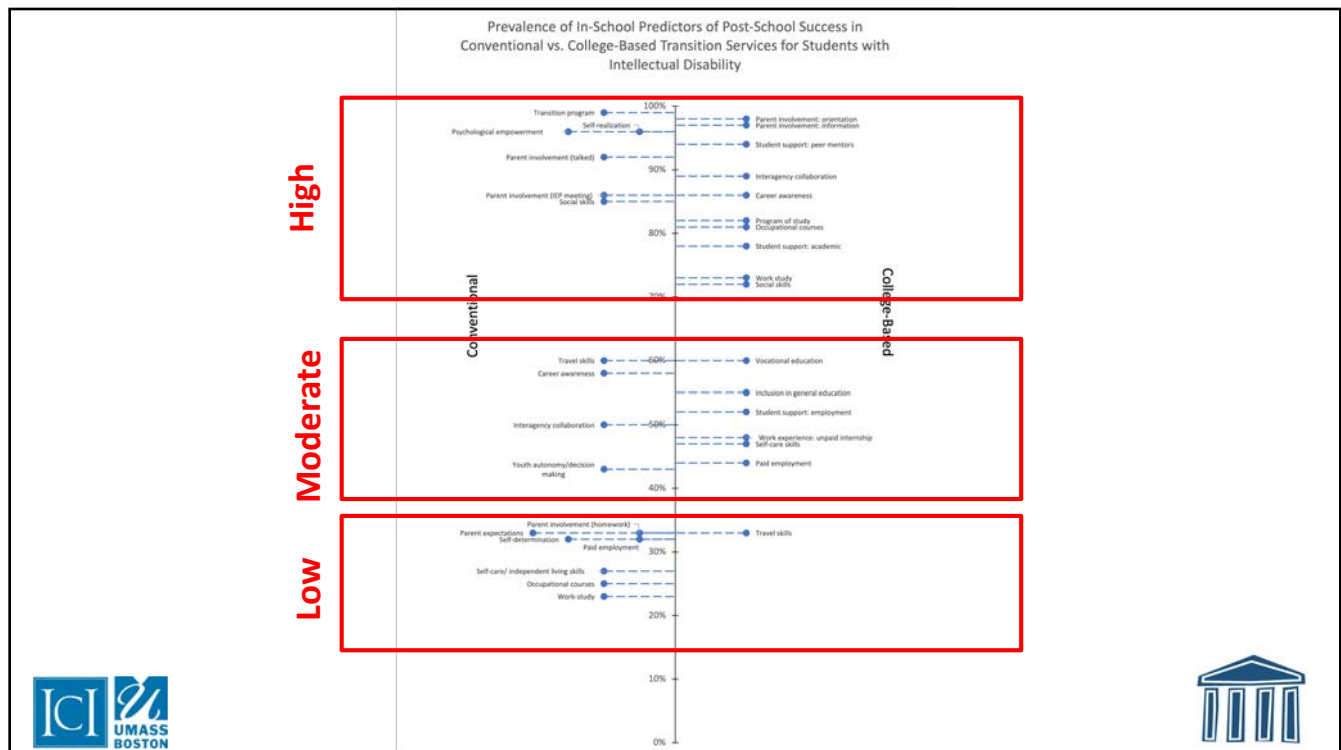


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Results & Implications

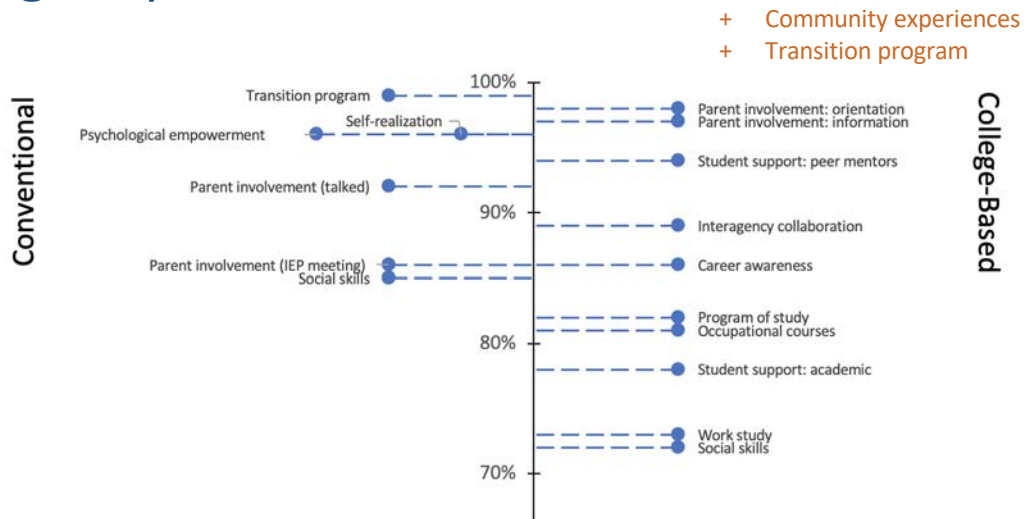


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Higher prevalence



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Higher Prevalence of In-School Predictors of Post-School Success



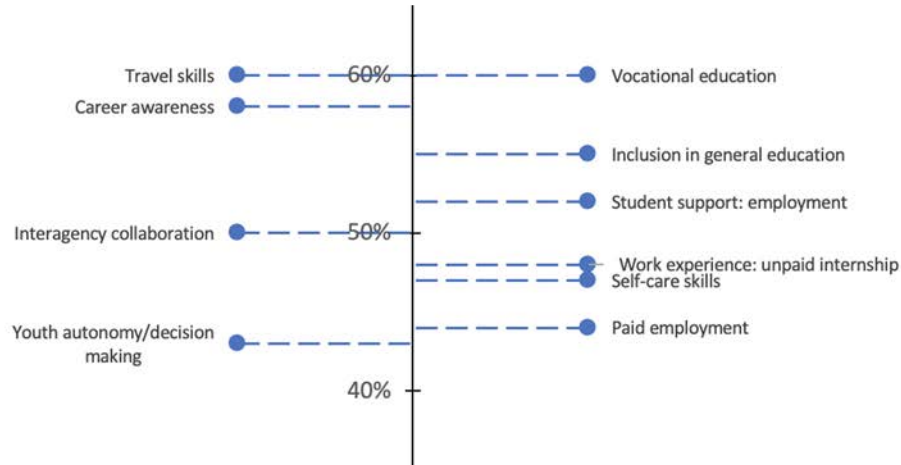
+ Community experiences and
Transition Program



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Moderate prevalence

Conventional

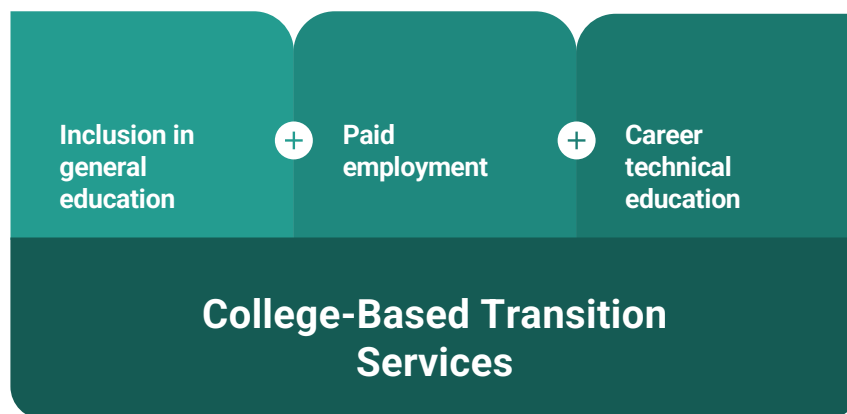


College-Based



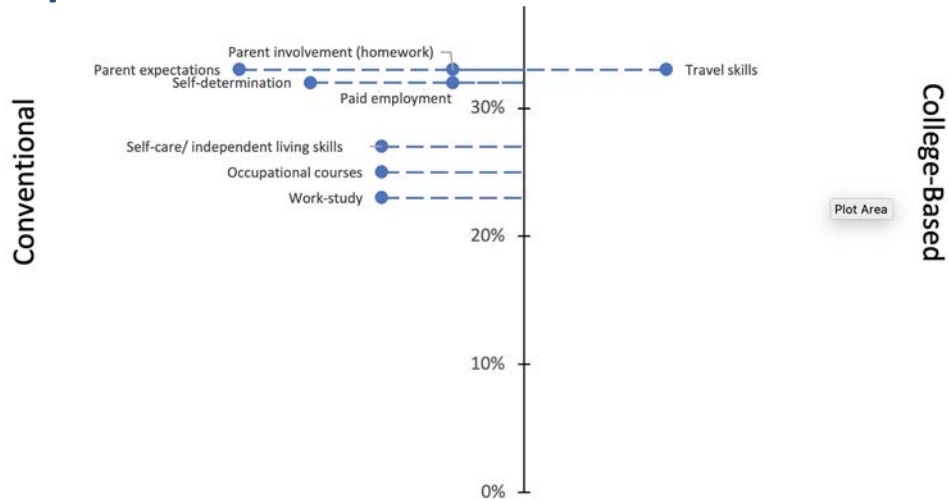
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Moderate Prevalence of In-School Predictors of Post-School Success



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Low prevalence



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Low Prevalence of In-School Predictors of Post-School Success



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Self-Determination

- NLTS 2012: Youth scored themselves highly on components of self-determination (psychological empowerment and self-realization)
 - Parent ratings of self-determination were lower
- TPSID dataset lacked data on self-determination
- Other studies may shed more light on CBTS and SD



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Schillaci, Parker, Grigal, & Paiewonsky (2021)

- An evaluation of one college-based transition services model, found CBT services had a significant effect on students' scores of self-determination
- Intervention students had substantively higher scores in six of seven domains of self-determination than comparison students enrolled in their districts' noncollege-based transition services.



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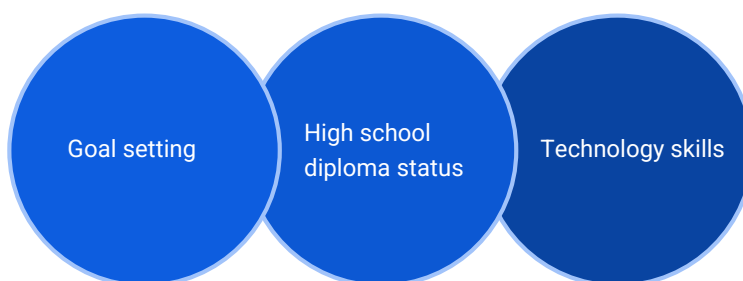
How might CBTS impact self-determination?

- setting goals and monitoring progress
- person-centered planning sessions
- choosing classes
- navigating the campus
- engaging in work training environments
- participating in social activities



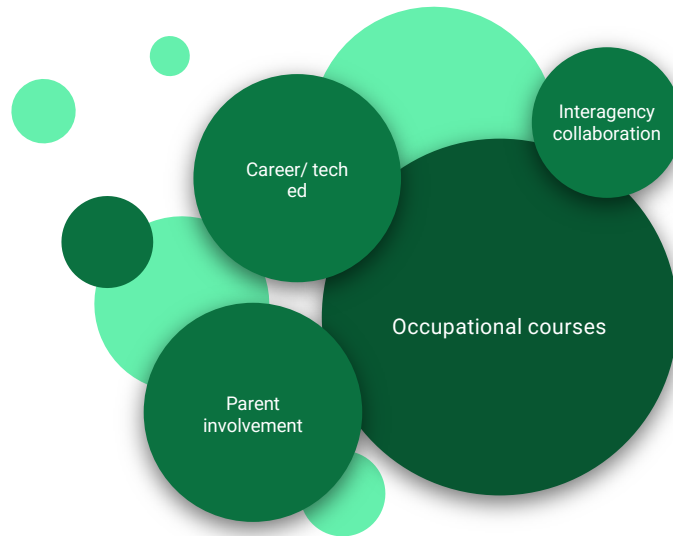
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Other areas where data are limited/non-existent



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Areas where the data do not tell the full story



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Prevalence does not mean quality

- Occupational courses - high prevalence but potentially segregated setting
- Parent involvement –IEP and information sharing
- The presence of a research-based predictor doesn't always help determine quality of transition programming
- Level of prevalence ≠ greater impact on outcomes



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What do our findings tell us?

In-school predictors of post-school success are more highly prevalent in CBT services than in conventional transition services

Does this mean college-based transition services offer a structure representative of post-school success?



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Considerations

- RBPs are not a complete list of practices needed to ensure post-school success.
- Available datasets provide limited data on extent to which RBPs are used



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Challenges

- CBT services minimally represented in our national data sources.
 - Only present in TPSID data
 - Not representative sample
 - Not designed to analyze CBTS
- It is hard to study something that is not well documented.



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It may be harder in the future....

Provision of college based transition services in TPSIDs has decreased over the last 5 years:

25% of students were transition aged youth in 2014-15

17% of students were transition aged youth in 2019-20

(2020-21 data shows 11% for the first year of cohort 3)



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We still need

- Better understanding of which research-based predictors are MOST important for students with ID and why
- Better datasets to enable us to understand the transition experiences of students with ID
- Increased availability of CBTS as a transition option for students with ID across the country



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CBTS Resources



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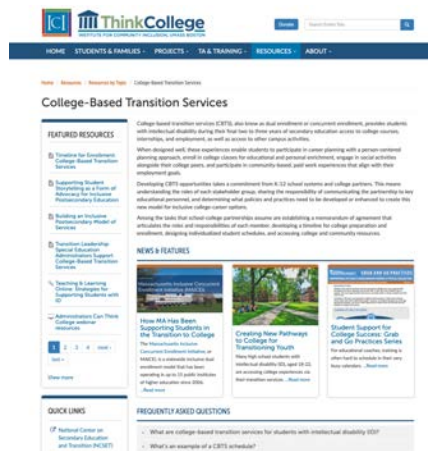
INCLUSIVE DUAL ENROLLMENT STUDENT EVALUATION TOOL

DOCUMENTING STUDENT GROWTH IN INCLUSIVE DUAL ENROLLMENT EXPERIENCES

HOW IEP TEAMS CAN USE DUAL ENROLLMENT EXPERIENCES TO DEVELOP ROBUST PLANS

SUPPORTING LIFE SKILLS DEVELOPMENT DURING A TYPICAL COLLEGE DAY

USING APPS AND TECHNOLOGY TO SUPPORT INCLUSIVE DUAL ENROLLMENT

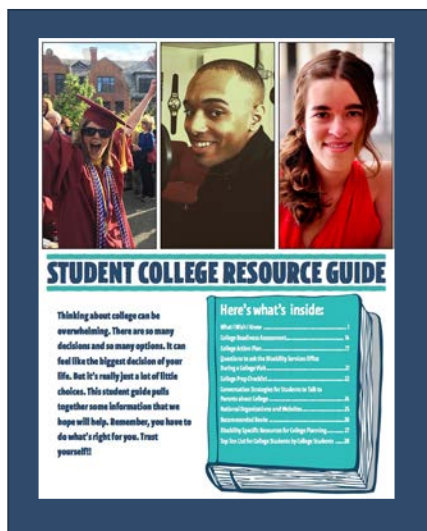


<https://thinkcollege.net/resources/innovation-exchange/dual-enrollment>



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Student Resource Guide



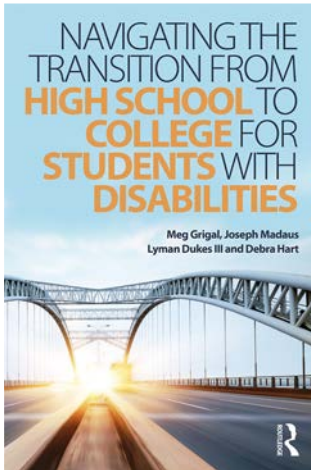
FREE

<https://thinkcollege.net/sites/default/files/files/resources/FinalStudentResourceGuide.pdf>



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For more information on transitioning to college for students with disabilities



<https://www.routledge.com>



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TO LEARN MORE

www.thinkcollege.net

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